Public Messaging and Behavior Change Systems for Circular Economies

TDOT

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The project, investigates how targeted message framing can promote sustainable behaviors aligned with the 3R principles: Reduce, Reuse, Recycle, and anti-littering practices. Using randomized control trials and a mixed-method approach, the study evaluated the impact of anthropomorphic, behavioral impact, and economic gain messages on participants' environmental actions. A Sustainability Awareness Index (SAI) was developed to assess baseline knowledge and its influence on behavioral response.

Pro-environmental Message Framing

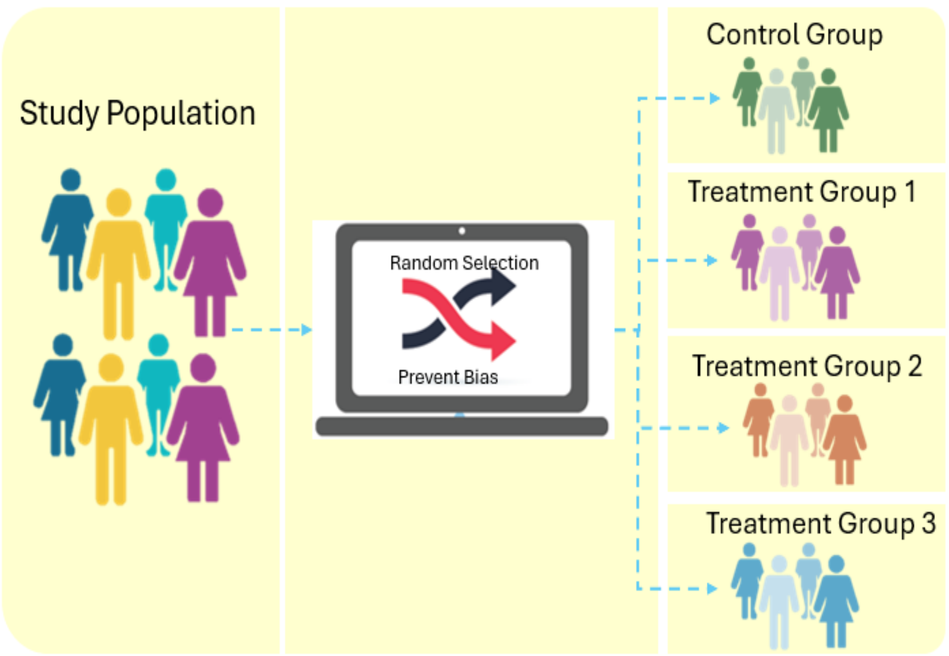
Definition

Message framing shapes perceptions and decisions by presenting information strategically.

Purpose

Influence individual perceptions and preferences.

Guide decision-making for desired behavioral outcomes.



Randomized Control Trials

Awe with Anthropomorphism

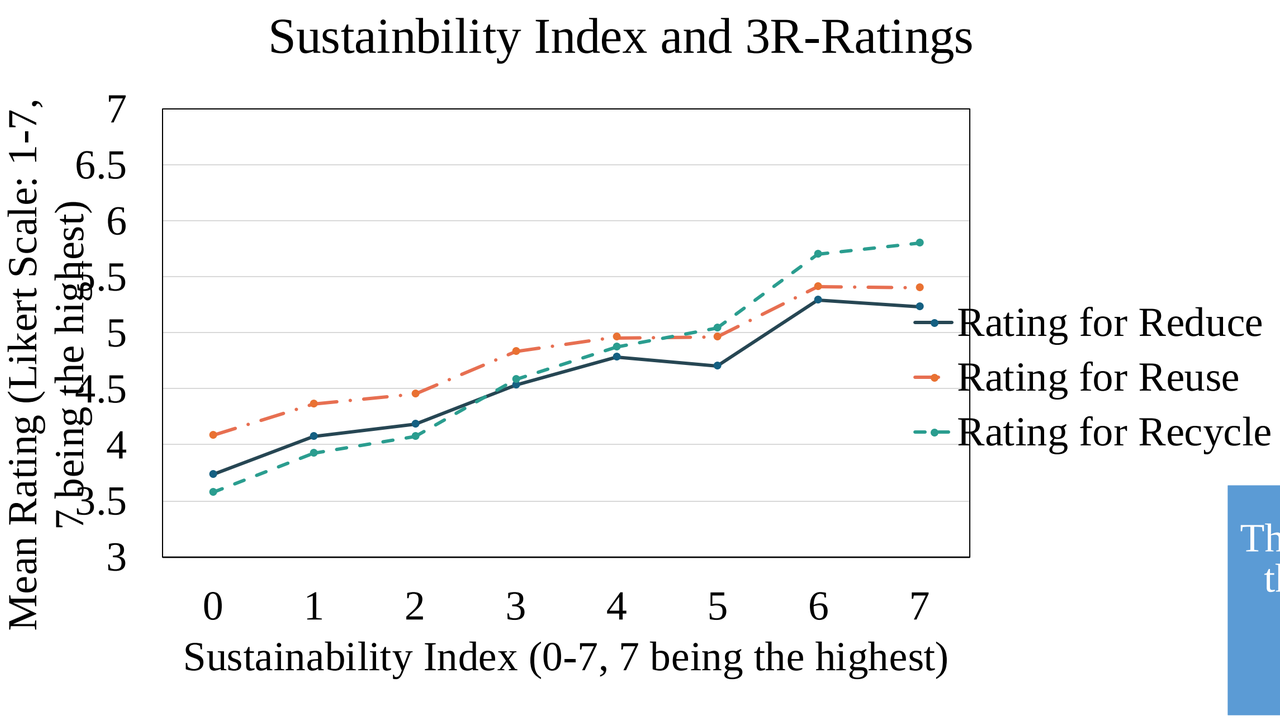
Power

Humor

Control

Anti-Litter Poster

3R Posters



The findings highlight the effectiveness of positive message framing,

Anthropomorphism and humor, in encouraging pro-environmental behaviors.

The study offers practical information through public messaging and digital nudging.